SALTED SESAME CHOCOLATE CHIP

YIELD	REST	OVEN	ENERGY COST
about 20 cookies	**2 h chilled, better overnight**	**350F, 8 min then 3-4 min after topping**	**$1.45 (12 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

227 g	Unsalted butter
150 g	Dark brown sugar
110 g	Caster sugar
1	Egg, extra large
2 tsp	Vanilla extract
245 g	All-purpose flour
3/4 tsp	Baking soda
1/4 tsp	Baking powder
1 tsp	Kosher salt
200 g	Dark chocolate, 70%, chopped
1 tsp	Espresso powder
2 tbsp	Black sesame seeds, toasted
142 g	White chocolate melting chips, for the shards
2 tbsp	Black sesame paste, for the shards
to taste, for topping	Maldon flaked salt

METHOD

1. Put the butter in a medium saucepan over medium heat and swirl it often, 5 to 7 minutes, until it is golden brown and smells nutty. Pour it into a heatproof bowl and leave it 5 to 7 minutes to cool.
2. Whisk both sugars into the warm butter until the mixture turns glossy and a shade paler.
3. Whisk in the egg and the vanilla, carrying on until it is smooth and you cannot feel sugar grain.
4. In a second bowl, whisk the flour, baking soda, baking powder and salt together.
5. Fold the dry mix into the wet and stop the moment it comes together. Fold through the chopped chocolate, the espresso powder and the black sesame seeds.
6. Cover and chill 2 hours, or overnight if you can plan that far ahead.
7. For the shards, melt the white chocolate chips over a double boiler until smooth and stir the sesame paste through. Spread it thin on a lined sheet, freeze 15 to 20 minutes to firm, then snap it into irregular pieces. Keep them in the fridge until the cookies come out.
8. Heat the oven to 350F. Scoop mounds of about 3 tbsp onto a lined sheet, 2 inches apart.
9. Bake 8 minutes, to the point where they have puffed but the centres are still soft.
10. Take the sheet out and bang it flat on the counter. Press 2 or 3 cold shards onto each cookie and add a pinch of Maldon.
11. Return them for 3 to 4 minutes, until the edges colour and the middles still look a little underdone.
12. Leave them on the sheet 5 minutes before moving them to a rack.

NOTES

Browned butter is the fat here, so there is no creaming stage and no room-temperature butter to plan for.
The pan bang after the first 8 minutes is what gives the flat ridged shape. Skipping it leaves them domed.
Make the shards during the chill. They go onto hot cookies but have to go on cold, or they slump instead of sitting proud.
Unsalted butter, with the salt weighed in separately, then flaked salt on top.
The source gives no yield. About 20 is what a 3 tbsp scoop gets out of roughly 1030 g of dough.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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